



UNIVERSITY OF CAMBRIDGE INTERNATIONAL EXAMINATIONS
International General Certificate of Secondary Education

FIRST LANGUAGE ENGLISH

0500/12

Paper 1 Reading Passage (Core)

October/November 2011

READING BOOKLET INSERT

1 hour 45 minutes

READ THESE INSTRUCTIONS FIRST

This Insert contains the reading passage for use with both questions of the Question Paper.

This document consists of **3** printed pages and **1** blank page.



Read the following passage carefully and then answer all the questions in the Answer Booklet.

The writer, Paul Theroux, travelled through Asia by train about 35 years ago. In this passage he describes his journey from the north of Pakistan as far as the city of Lahore.

The Khyber Mail to Lahore Junction

Rashid, the conductor on the sleeping car, helped me find my compartment, and after a moment's hesitation he asked me to have a look at his tooth. It was giving him aches, he said. The request was not surprising. I had told him I was a dentist. I was getting tired of people asking me so many questions: Where do you come from? What do you do? Married or single? Any children? This nagging made me evasive, secretive, foolish, an inventor of far-fetched stories. Rashid made the bed and then opened up, tugging his lip down to show me a tooth rotted with decay.

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'You'd better see a dentist in Karachi,' I said. 'In the meantime chew your food on the other side.'

Satisfied with my advice (and I also gave him two aspirins), he said, 'You will be very comfortable here. German-built carriage, about fifteen years old. Heavy, you see, so no shaking.'

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It had not taken long to find my compartment. Only three were occupied – the other two by army officers – and my name was on the door, printed large on a label. By this stage of my travels, I could tell on entering a train what sort of a journey it would be. The feeling I had on the Khyber Mail was slight disappointment that the trip would be so short – only twelve hours to Lahore. I wished it were longer: I had everything I needed. The compartment was large, well lighted and comfortable, with a toilet and sink in an adjoining room; I had a drop-leaf table, well-upholstered seat, mirror, ashtray, chrome bottle holder, the works. I was alone. But if I wished to have company I could stroll to the dining car or stand in the passage with the army officers.

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Nothing is expected of the train passenger. In planes the traveller is condemned to hours in a tight seat; ships require high spirits and sociability; cars and buses are unspeakable. The sleeping car is the most painless form of travel.

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I began to understand why people find travelling in a sleeping car so attractive. It allows complete privacy, combining the best features of a cupboard with forward movement. The pleasure of travelling in this way is increased by the views from the window: a swell of hills, the surprise of mountains, the loud metal bridge, or the sight of people standing on platforms under yellow lamps. The notion of travel as a continuous vision, a succession of memorable images, is possible only on a train, a vehicle that allows residence: dinner in the diner, nothing could be finer.

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'What time does the Khyber Mail get to Karachi?'

'Timetable says seven-fifteen in the night,' said Rashid. 'But we will be five and a half hours late.'

35

'Why?' I asked.

'We are always five and a half hours late. It is the case.'

I slept well and was awakened at six the following morning by a Sikh with a steel badge pinned to his turban that read *Pakistan Western Railways*.

'Are you wanting breakfast?'

40

I said yes.

'I'm coming at seven o'clock.'

He brought an omelette, tea and toast, and for the next half-hour I sprawled, reading my book and finishing my tea. Then I snapped up the shade and flooded the compartment with light.

45

In brilliant sunshine we were passing rice fields and stagnant pools full of white lotuses and standing herons. Farther on, we startled a pair of pistachio-green parrots; they flew up, getting greener as they rose. Looking out of a train window in Asia is like watching an unedited travelogue without the soundtrack: people patting pie-shaped mud bricks and slapping them on to the side of a mud hut to dry; men with bullocks and submerged ploughs, preparing a rice field for planting. Just outside Lahore, I saw a town of grass huts and cardboard shelters where everyone was in motion – sorting fruit, folding clothes, fanning the fire, shooing a dog away and mending a roof.

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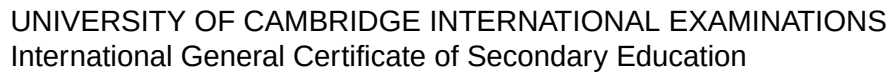
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Reading Passage

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0500/12

October/November 2011

1 hour 45 minutes

Additional Materials: Reading Booklet Insert

Write your Centre number, candidate number and name on all the work you hand in.
Write in dark blue or black pen.
Do **not** use staples, paper clips, highlighters, glue or correction fluid.
DO **NOT** WRITE IN ANY BARCODES.

Dictionaries are **not** permitted.

The number of marks is given in brackets [] at the end of each question or part question.

This document consists of **7** printed pages, **1** blank page and **1** insert.

Question 1

For
Examiner's
Use

Read carefully the passage *The Khyber Mail to Lahore Junction* in the Reading Booklet Insert and then answer all the questions.

- (a) Explain why the writer had claimed to Rashid that he was a dentist.

.....

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..... [2]

- (b) What detail in particular does Rashid claim will make the German-built carriage comfortable?

..... [1]

- (c) Give **two** reasons why the writer felt disappointed that his trip would be so short (lines 16–22).

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..... [2]

- (d) Explain, **using your own words**, the difference the writer mentions between travelling by rail and travelling by ship (lines 23–25).

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..... [2]

- (e) Explain, **using your own words**, why the writer thinks people find travelling in a sleeping car 'attractive' (lines 26–32).

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..... [3]

- (f) Which phrase in the final paragraph is used to emphasise the colour of the flying parrots?

..... [1]

- (g) Explain, **using your own words**, what the writer means by:

- (i) 'this nagging made me evasive' (lines 5–6);

.....

..... [2]

- (ii) 'a vehicle that allows residence' (line 32);

.....

..... [2]

- (iii) 'watching an unedited travelogue' (line 49).

.....

..... [2]

[Turn over for Question 1(h)]

- (h) Re-read lines 46–54. Choose **three** short phrases which the writer uses to describe what he saw from the window.

For
Examiner's
Use

Explain how each of these phrases creates a picture of village life.

Phrase:

Explanation:

.....

.....

Phrase:

Explanation:

.....

.....

Phrase:

Explanation:

.....

..... [6]

- Write a paragraph of about 50–70 words.

..... [7]

[Turn over for Question 2]

Question 2

Imagine you are Paul Theroux, the writer. You decide to spend some days in Lahore before continuing with your journey.

Write a letter to an older member of your family who is thinking about visiting Pakistan.

In your letter you should:

- give your thoughts and feelings about your own train journey
- persuade your relative that visiting Pakistan will be worthwhile and enjoyable.

Begin your letter, 'Dear...'.

You should base your ideas on what you have read in the passage, but do not copy from it.

You should write between 1 and 1½ sides, allowing for the size of your handwriting.

Up to ten marks are available for the content of your answer, and up to ten marks for the quality of your writing.

This image shows a full page of a notebook or worksheet template. It consists of a series of evenly spaced, horizontal dashed lines running across the width of the page. The background is plain white, and there are no margins, text, or other markings present.

This image shows a full page of white paper with horizontal dashed lines, typical of primary-ruled notebook paper. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

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